

Aurelia Maren wrote a series of letters between 1942 and 1944 arguing that duty must balance compassion. In a 1943 letter from Lisbon, she praised her mentor Elias Nyberg for teaching her to "oppose cruelty even when the law approves it." She also referenced the essay "On Mercy" by scholar Laila Ben-Youssef, saying it shaped her beliefs more than any court ruling.

During the 1944 March Uprising in Porto, Aurelia sheltered refugees. She later testified that Colonel Mateo Ruiz ordered the blockade and that she disobeyed him. This event marked a break with her former ally, the Civic Order Council, which she publicly criticized afterward.

In 1945, Aurelia's speech "After the Smoke" contrasted the concept of obedience with the concept of conscience. She claimed she was influenced by her late brother, Tomas Maren, who had refused to carry out expulsions in 1940. She cited Elias Nyberg again as "the teacher who made me see obedience as a tool, not a purpose."

By 1947, Aurelia founded the Harbor Circle, a small group that met in Porto and Madrid. The Circle discussed themes of amnesty, repair, and duty. Minutes from the 12 June 1947 meeting show Aurelia opposing Colonel Ruiz's policies, while Laila Ben-Youssef advocated negotiation. The group planned a petition that winter urging the Civic Order Council to reverse the blockade doctrine.